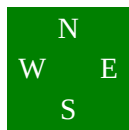


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 6 2
♥ 3
♦ 9 8 4 2
♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ Q 10 9 4
♥ A Q 8 6
♦ A K
♣ A J 4



♠ 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ K 9 8 5 2

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ K J 10 9 4
♦ Q 6 5
♣ 7

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North

North plays 6♥. East leads the ♠8. To play the ♠A or not to play the ♠A, that is the question.

Loser List: ♠ = 2? : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

At first thought it seems the ♠ lead has saved you a guess in the suit. By playing low in dummy you will force West to put on the King, (if he has it), winning the trick but leaving you with a pretty good position in ♠s.

That's why it's good to have second thoughts at the Bridge table. Think about the meaning of the ♠8 lead. If it is fourth down, then the Rule of 11 tells you that there will be 3 cards higher than the 8 spread among South, West, and North. **BUT YOU CAN SEE 4 HIGHER CARDS.** So your conclusion is that East has **NOT** made a fourth-down lead, but rather has led top-of-nothing, top-of-a-doubleton, or perhaps a singleton.

You don't know which of the above, but you do know that West holds both the ♠ K J. The danger is if the ♠8 is a singleton and you play low from dummy they could get a ♠ trick and a ♠ ruff. So don't play low from dummy. Win the ♠A at trick 1, pull trumps and then play ♠s from dummy toward your ♠ Q 10 9, giving West the ♠K but finessing him out of his known ♠J.

If West led the ♠8 from ♠ 8 6 2 then it wouldn't matter whether you played the ♠A or not, you would always make the contract.

If West led the ♠8 from ♠ 8 6 or ♠ 8 2 then it also wouldn't matter whether you played the ♠A or not, you would always make the contract.

If West led the singleton ♠8 then you had better play the ♠A or you will be down before you start.

It is unlikely that West would lead the ♠8 from any holding containing one or both of the honors.

First find out about Major suit fits by bidding Stayman. So bid 3♣ and partner says 3♥. What now?

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Feel free to use Blackwood. But if partner shows 3 Aces you only have enough points to bid 6, and if he shows 2 Aces you would still bid 6. So Blackwood will keep you out of slam if he has only 1 Ace. Or, you could just take a chance and bid 6♥.

The contract would be 6♥ played by South.

To rotate the hands and make North the declarer

Board 3

South Deals
None Vul

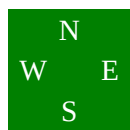
♠ 9 8 6
♥ Q J 9 2
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 10 5

♠ 7 5

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A Q 9 8 4 2



♠ Q J 10 4 2

♥ 10

♦ A 9 5 4 3

♣ 7 6

♠ A K 3

♥ A 7 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K J 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
the trick and West switches to the ♠9.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2/3

This looks like a walk in the park. Play 2 rounds of trumps, and if they split 3-2 go ahead and force the master trump out. The rest of the tricks would then be yours.

But East shows out on the second trump lead. Ouch!

DO NOT PLAY ANOTHER TRUMP! If you do, then West will pull all the trumps and then East/West will win some ♦s. Many, many ♦s.

Instead just start playing good ♣s. West can ruff in whenever he wants but you will maintain trump control. West can get both master trumps but nothing else.

It is usually correct to leave a master trump undrawn, just let the defender ruff in whenever he wants.

Here that principle applied even though there were **TWO** master trumps out.

Never mind trying to decide how to show the ♣ suit; with a 4-card Major your obligation is to use Stayman.

You say 2♣ and partner bids 2♥. What now?

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You say 2♣ and partner bids 2♥. What now?

Again, never mind the ♣ suit. You have an 8-card Major fit and enough points for game, so you bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦K. The ♦K holds

Board 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 8 5 2
♥ Q 10 5 2
♦ 9 7 4 2
♣ K 8

♠ A J 6
♥ K 8 4
♦ A K 6
♣ 7 5 4 2



♠ 10 9 7 4
♥ J 9 6
♦ 10 8 5
♣ A Q J

♠ K Q 3
♥ A 7 3
♦ Q J 3
♣ 10 9 6 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass
3NT by North